

Time for change

NO, NO, THIS ISN'T ABOUT MITHUN'S COLUMN BEING SHIFTED TO PAGE 1. For those of you reading for long enough, you know that this is normal for the Managing Editor who looks after the mag on a daily basis. Besides, you've probably grown sick of seeing my face for over a decade :-)

This column is about trying to get inside your minds and figure out how to serve you better. It's also about letting you in on a few insider secrets. For example, did you know that for the last couple of years, I've been unhappy with one particular aspect of the Digit package – the DVD. It's just old, and doesn't feel right for us – the guys who love writing about cutting-edge tech. Speaking of old, I should know; I was there when we started making DVDs, and know first-hand the pain of putting together a dual-layer DVD on a 128 kilobit internet pipe! You think all my hair falling out was a coincidence?

The Digit DVD holds special memories for me. From every single letter of appreciation I used to read and eagerly reply to, to spending 12 days non-stop in office with a programmer trying to get him to build a Flash interface that mimicked Windows... it is a part of Digit that I have (quite literally) dedicated blood, sweat and tears to. The tears came from trying to get ActionScript in Flash to work, and far greater men than me have suffered the same fate. The sweat came from sitting through power cuts on weekends in Navi Mumbai, inside a blisteringly hot office in April. The blood... well that was caused by a road accident I had while rushing to office to remake a DVD Master because the one I had sent had failed in production – an occurrence more common than you think. It was always worth it in the end though, because the positive feedback I got from you in the form of email or on the forum when I posted the content list would put a grin on my face.

This is all reminiscing though, and personally, I feel it's time to move on from the physical DVD once and for all. However, this is not something I can just decide to do, because it's a family decision for us here at Digit, which means you have to be involved as well. It is, after all, one of the defining characteristics of Digit. The CDs and DVDs are quite often

the only reason many kids of the early 2000s would spend pocket money on a magazine. For many, the CDs/DVDs were the very first thing they got to in the package, often only coming back to read the mag several days later...

Those days are gone though. Most laptops don't even ship with optical drives anymore, as do quite a few assembled and branded PCs... I can't tell you how often readers have written in to say how useless the DVD is to them. Then again, I also get letters saying the DVD provided software that changed someone's life, and taught them how to build an app, and other similar stories.

In order to do this, we're running a survey this month, and I urge you to please fill it in. Even if you don't care either way, say so. Since we're running a survey anyway, I figured I'd even ask your opinion on everything else in the package, and see if we can improve every item that comes to you.

I'm thinking we could just stop the DVD and make it an 'eDVD' – something online, accessible to buyers of Digit. I'm envisioning a PC/Laptop and a mobile version, so you don't just get to experience our pick of Windows and Linux software, but also iOS and Android apps and games. Best of all, no data limits, so we don't have to pick and choose and be stingy with space on the DVD. Forget 8 GB, we could collect and share 80 GB a month if we wanted to. Of course, the downside is you have to use your bandwidth to access that.

The Dvice book we included last month (with SKOAR on the other side) was my vision for a replacement, but that depends on how much you like the idea of a hands-on/DIY style book. Yes, we're not thinking of 'replacing' the DVD with an eDVD. We want to give you the eDVD as well as something else as a bonus.

Remember, if you hate the idea of losing the DVD, I especially want to hear from you in the survey. If the majority of you tell me to shut up, I will humbly forget all about this plan. So the ball is squarely in your court.

Take the survey NOW please: <https://digit.in/Survey2019> 



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